# MEMORANDUM

**To:** Director of National Intelligence
**From:** Xocas Alvarez Jorge
**Date:** July 2026
**Re:** Standing rhetoric–action baseline for foreign AI governance

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## Bottom line

NSPM-11 tasks you with analyzing foreign AI governance that could threaten U.S. security. That tasking assumes something we cannot currently do: distinguishing a state that is building real controls over frontier systems from one that has only learned to talk about them. This is not a collection gap. It is a measurement gap.

## Recommendation

Build the measurement. An annual, unclassified-at-the-baseline product scoring each state of interest on the distance between what it says about AI risk and what it does.

- Multilateral statements and voting records on AI governance.
- Export licensing and compute procurement behavior.
- Enforcement actions taken against its own developers.
- The output is a ranked table, with the score broken out by component and briefable in a page.
- Analysts covering foreign AI programs would use it directly. So would State teams who need to know which commitments have historically been load-bearing before they walk into a bilateral.

## Why this is tractable now

- The method exists and has been validated on a harder problem: roughly 10,000 UN General Debate speeches, 862,039 UNGA voting records, V-Dem regime data, SIPRI transfer records, and seventy arms-control treaties, 1970–2023.
- Nothing new has to be collected. The inputs are open sources already ingested, which makes the first iteration an analysis problem rather than a collection one.
- Rhetorical alignment with a treaty regime does not reliably predict compliance with it.
- States that ratified the Arms Trade Treaty began adopting treaty language roughly four years before ratification ($p = 0.008$). Rhetoric ran ahead of commitment, and commitment ran ahead of behavior.
- This matters now because the June executive order governs frontier model security through a voluntary framework. Arms control is the closest precedent we have for what a state does when its stated position is treated as evidence of its intent.

## Anticipated objection

- *States will optimize against the metric, producing vaguer commitments rather than better behavior.*
- The objection is real, but the failure mode is legible. A state that stops making specific claims has told us something. Score specificity alongside consistency and the evasion becomes reportable in itself.

## Cost

- Two analysts and one engineer. Six months to a first product, on open data already in hand.

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*Note: the pipeline and findings cited above were designed and implemented by the author within a co-authored arms-control study. The analysis, the method, and the proposal set out in this memo are my own.*